



Nursery Progression of Skills

This document maps out the progression of skills from Autumn 1 to Summer 2 for each area of learning, prime and specific. It has been created in consultation with Birth to 5 Matters and Development Matters. It is also closely linked with the Play Skills Provision map, which evidences how our provision is facilitating this progression of skills. Teachers in Nursery will use this document to plan.

Areas of Learning:

1. [Communication & Language](#)
2. [Personal Social and Emotional Development](#)
3. [Physical Development](#)
4. [Literacy](#)
5. [Maths](#)
6. [Understanding the World](#)
7. [Expressive Arts and Design](#)

Communication & Language				
Area	Baseline	Autumn 2	Spring 2	Summer 2
Listening, Attention & Understanding	I can answer to my own name I can follow instructions with three key words (e.g. can you wash dolly' face?) <i>Consider if a child can understand instructions in home language</i> I can focus attention during an adult led session in a small group or 1 to 1 for	I stop what I am doing and listen when I hear someone call my name or hear the doorbell ring I can focus attention during an adult led carpet session for 5 minutes When you ask me to do something like come and put your coat on I will do it if I am not really busy playing	I can maintain attention and concentrate on an adult led carpet activity for 8 minutes I can follow an instruction that is given to me even if I am busy	I can focus attention during an adult led carpet session for 10 minutes I can focus longer attention at a self-chosen learning opportunity I understand prepositions such as under, on top, behind for example if you ask me to put my teddy 'under' the bed – I can.



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	2/3 minutes if the subject interests and motivates me I can listen to a short story when you make different noises or use different voices I can point to an object when you ask me for example 'where is the.....' I can recognise and respond to familiar sounds, e.g. Tidy up music or a signal for quiet such as a tambourine	When you ask me questions like 'what do I need to cut bread' I know it is a knife I can help you when you ask me to put something away or do something like 'put your shoes in the basket' I can follow a simple instruction such as 'can you give me the ball' I am beginning to understand what you expect me to do when you ask me to 'mop up the juice'	I can take part in short exchanges with others if I am interested in what is being said	I can follow a two-part instruction for example 'can you collect the cups and then put them on the table' I can understand simple 'why?' questions such as – 'why do you think the caterpillar got fat?'
Speaking	I can pronounce one syllable words clearly and some multi-syllabic (with some immature speech sounds). I can use very simple sentences with 3 or 4 words I can ask for help if I need it I am rapidly learning new words and beginning to use them correctly and in context	I can talk about what we are doing now and what might happen later or tomorrow for example I can talk about the visual timetable to say what is coming next I am beginning to ask simple questions such as 'when is mummy coming?' I am learning lots of new vocabulary for example the names of animals,	I am beginning to expand my sentences for example 'mummy gone shop and buy me chocolate' (4 – 6 words) I can say when I am feeling happy, sad or upset	I am beginning to talk more extensively about things I am building up a breadth of vocabulary linked to routines and familiar activities I am beginning to use talk to pretend I can join in with my favourite songs and rhymes – not always getting the words completely right



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	I am beginning to use a variety of questions using what, where, who and why	weather, days of the week, feelings etc I am learning the new vocabulary necessary for Nursery routines, rules and boundaries	I can predict what might happen in a story I am beginning to use language I have heard, in my role play – for example calling to my friends 'It's tidy up time' or 'It's story time' I can sometimes use the correct tense (sometimes using 'runned' for 'ran' or 'swimmed' for 'swam') I can join in with a repeated refrain such as 'we cant go over it – we cant go under it' I can start a conversation with familiar people and ask questions	I can take part in a reciprocal conversation with familiar people (3+ exchanges) I can say most sounds clearly when speaking but may need some support with sounds such as r, j, th, ch, sh and with some multi-syllabic words such as 'hippopotamus'
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Personal, Social & Emotional Development				
Area	Baseline	Autumn 2	Spring 2	Summer 2
Self Regulation	I know that I can go to an familiar adult for comfort when I am upset and I am beginning to be able to be distracted with comforting conversation or an object I am beginning to participate in collective cooperation as my experience of routines and understanding of some boundaries grows	I know that sometimes I cannot do the things I want to do for example running around inside the nursery classroom I am beginning to understand the rules and boundaries of nursery and I am proud if I am given praise or a sticker I know that I can go to a familiar adult for comfort when I am upset and I am beginning to be able to be distracted with comforting conversation or an object I am beginning to understand that I can't always have what I want, when I want	I know that there are rules and boundaries at school but I cannot always adhere to them without support I am beginning to understand that behaviour expectations can be different in different situations for example can run outside and not inside	I understand the rules and boundaries in school and can adhere to them the majority of the time. I am beginning to use vocabulary regarding how I feel for example happy or sad and I am able to regulate my behaviour accordingly I can explain to an adult what has happened when I am upset. I am able to solve small conflicts through talking and being assertive eg 'stop it I don't like it' or 'can I have a turn when you are finished?'
Managing Self	I can separate from my parent/carer when I come in to nursery each day sometimes with support from an	I can separate from my parent/carer when I come in to nursery each day I know that sometimes other children may want the toys I am playing with	I can talk about my likes and dislikes I am gradually learning that my actions have consequences and maybe not always the consequences I would like such as being given time out if I hurt another child	I can play with others, sharing what I am using, with support from an adult I am developing confidence, risk taking and trying new things



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	adult that I have got to know I can say goodbye to my family when coming to nursery. I can say when I need to go to the toilet	and I will need help from a grown up to help me to share I can select and use activities and resources with help when necessary	I am becoming more confident in new social situations	I react to praise by showing pride and a can-do attitude I am showing increasing independence when I put on my coat, get dressed and undressed
Building Relationships	I show an interest in other children's play I watch what other children are doing before I join in with them	I am beginning to talk to and make friends with other children and grown-ups that I know I can make up ideas and things to do in my own play for example making a cup of tea in the home corner	I have formed good bonds with some adults and children I can play with my friends co-operatively most of the time I can show empathy for the feelings of others for example giving my friend a tissue if they are crying I am beginning to understand how others are feeling I am becoming more outgoing with unfamiliar people when I am in an environment that I know is safe	I can play In a group with my friends. I can make up ideas for things to do and games to play. I will ask my friends to play with me. I am developing my confidence in a range of social situations I can seek out companionship with adults and other children, sharing experiences and play ideas.

Physical Development ([whole school progression map](#))

Area	Baseline	Autumn 2	Spring 2	Summer 2
Gross motor	I am steady on my feet and can move in a variety of ways I can run in a straight line I can climb up 3/4 rungs of a ladder on climbing equipment I maybe beginning to show preference for my dominant hand/leg/foot I can ride a tricycle I can squat with steadiness and rise to my feet without using my hands I am becoming more confident to climb on play equipment	I can jump into the air with both feet leaving the floor and I can jump forward a small distance I can begin to walk, run and climb on different levels and surfaces I can run in a straight line I can climb up and down stairs by placing both of my feet on each step while holding the handrail for support I maybe beginning to show preference for my dominant hand/leg/foot	I can match my developing physical skills to tasks for example I can decide whether to crawl, walk or run across a plank depending on its length and/or width I can catch and throw a large ball with developing control I can gallop (pre-skipping) around an open space I can move in a range of ways revising and refining walking, running, crawling and jumping I can move more confidently in other ways such as skipping, hopping and crawling I can climb confidently on a climbing frame independently	I can go up and down stairs and steps using one foot per <i>step</i> (<i>this may be more difficult for children living in flats as they will not have had the practice necessary to be able to do this</i>) I can move around, sometimes running and change direction in order to not bump into things. I can stand on one leg when it is modelled for me for a small amount of time I can catch a large ball when it is thrown to me I am beginning to feel more confident to use a range of equipment including climbing frames safely, understanding sensible risk taking. I am beginning to show some hand/eye coordination when throwing and catching I am continuing to develop my movement/balance/riding and ball skills



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	I can move confidently in a range of ways such as walking, running, crawling and jumping I can Jump in the air with both feet off of the ground I can jump forwards	I can sit on a balance bike and scoot myself along I can wave my arms around using ribbons to make large circles and lines in the air – sometimes using up and down and circular movements I can move in response to music or rhythms played on a musical instrument e.g. a drum or shaker I can use large movements when using a paintbrush, up and down and circular		
Fine motor	I can turn the pages of a book sometimes several at once (see reading for pleasure)	I can turn the pages of a book one at a time (see reading for pleasure)	I am learning how to use a knife and fork (knife for cutting) I can thread large objects onto a piece of string	I can use scissors to make snips in paper I can make lines/marks that I want with a pencil



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	I am beginning to show some control when using paintbrushes, crayons and playdough cutters I can use a cup to drink but may sometimes still spill my drink I can use large movements when using large paintbrushes or large chalks	Shows increasing control in holding a variety of objects and tools such as jugs, hammers and mark making tools I can use a cup to drink I am beginning to show preference for a dominant hand I can hold a pencil to make marks in a fist grip I can imitate patterns for pre-handwriting e.g. zig zag, clockwise and anti clockwise circles	I can use large tweezers to pick up objects such as pom poms, pasta etc I can use a fist/four finger pencil grip	I am beginning to write my name independently (<i>letters may not be correctly formed</i>) I am beginning to move from a four-finger grip to a three-finger grip I can use a knife, fork and spoon I can use one-handed tools and equipment I can thread smaller items onto a piece of string I can use tweezers to pick up smaller items such as buttons or raisins I am beginning to show some hand/eye coordination when throwing and catching
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Literacy				
Area	Baseline	Autumn 2	Spring 2	Summer 2
Comprehension	I Have 1 or 2 favourite songs, rhymes or jingles I enjoy using musical instruments playing them along with the words and rhythm of a song I enjoy sharing a book with a familiar adult	I am beginning to make comments about my favourite stories such as 'The caterpillar is now fat' I am engaging in extended conversations about stories learning new vocabulary for example 'it is now a butterfly' or having a back and forth conversation I can fill in a missing word or phrase in a known rhyme eg Humpty Dumpty sat on a ****	(Five key concepts about print: - (1) print has meaning – (2) the names of the different parts of a book – (3) print can have different purposes – (4) page sequencing – (5) we read English text from left to right and from top to bottom) I know that print carries meaning (1) I know that words in books tell me things and where the word starts on the page I am beginning to understand the structure of stories for example once upon a time is the beginning and the end is the end I can repeat words and phrases from familiar stories	Five key concepts about print: - print has meaning - the names of the different parts of a book - print can have different purposes - page sequencing - we read English text from left to right and from top to bottom) I understand that print carries meaning and has different purposes (3) I understand that in English print is from left to right and top to bottom and that books are read sequentially from page 1 onwards (5) I know that the pages of a book have a sequential order and I know that you cannot start reading a story from the back of the book (4)



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Word Reading	I am beginning to associate my name with my photo when I self-register I point to things in a book when I am being read to I can recognise some logos that have a meaning for me for example the Google logo or Apple for a phone or Ipad	I can recognise my name for example choosing the correct name to self-register I respond to pictures and words in a book that is being read to me I can recognise logos that have a meaning for me for example the Google logo or Apple for a phone or Ipad	I like to look at and enjoy print and digital books I know that print has different purposes	I understand that print carries meaning and can identify some logos/brand names that I know I can count or clap syllables and sounds in words for example C-A-T (3 claps) SEP-TEM-BER (3 claps) I am beginning to understand the concept of words and sentences I know the difference between pictures and words I can recognise when words start with the same sound such as sizzling sausages
Writing	I am able to take part in mark making activities in a variety of different ways for example using crayons and chalk on paper, my fingers in sand or cornflour or using a touch screen on an Ipad	I can make different marks with my fingers in corn flour, shaving foam etc (including lines, zig zags and circles) I am beginning to make marks with a variety of tools such as sticks in mud, large paint brushes in water, in the air with	I can make lines and marks that I want Sometimes I can tell you about my drawings and mark making and I can tell you what my mark making says I can tell you what I think it means when I see you modelling writing I can copy some letters of my name	I can make marks to represent writing and they include lines and circles I am beginning to assign meaning to the marks I make I can write my name independently (letters may not be correctly formed)



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		ribbon sticks, on the floor with large chalk I am beginning to give some meaning to marks as I draw or paint	I know the difference between drawing and writing	I am mark making with some letter shapes I can identify some letters on a keyboard I can use some knowledge I may have gained about print and letters in my mark making e.g. some letters of my name or an M for Morrisons or mummy I am beginning to understand that writing is directional from left to right and top to bottom in English
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Maths				
Area	Baseline	Autumn 2	Spring 2	Summer 2
Number	I can say some number names I am beginning to show an interest in sorting things for example by colour I can use my fingers to indicate 1 or 2	I can count to 5 by rote especially when singing number songs or number rhymes with actions I have a good number sense of one and two items. For example I use number words like one or two and sometimes respond accurately when asked to give one or two things. I can recognise my birthday number	I can say one number for each item in order up to 3 for example I can hand 3 pencils to an adult counting 1-2-3 as I pass the pencils I can say numbers in the correct order past 5 (by rote) I know that numbers tell me how many things there are all together for example there are 4 biscuits on the plate I can match some numerals to the right number of objects such as the numeral 3 to 3 balls in a box I know when there are the same number of things like 2 cakes – 1 for you and 1 for me I talk about numbers that I see when we are outside for example the bus number I can use my fingers to represent a given number up to 5	I know that I can count actions as well as objects up to 5 I can say 1 number for each object in order to 5 (1:1 correspondence) I can count by rote usually linking this to number rhymes and songs sometimes up to 10 I can notice a difference in quantities for example I know if I have more pieces of fruit than my friend I can give a small number of objects from a group when asked I am beginning to match numerals with a small amount of objects up to 5 I am beginning to count in my play I can subitise up to 3 I know that the last number I count signifies the number of objects in the



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				group
Numeric al Patterns	I am becoming familiar with patterns in the daily routines I can give you 1 or 2 objects when you ask me to	I am becoming familiar with patterns in the daily routines I am able to notice patterns and arrange things in patterns I am beginning to notice a simple repeating pattern	I can describe a sequence of events using the words first and then I can notice a simple repeating pattern and can correct an error I can say when my friend has more pieces of apple than I do and I can use the language more, fewer, less I can make some comparisons between objects relating to length, size, weight, capacity such as I am taller than my friend	I know that some numbers are of particular significance to me such as my age and door number I can recognise simple patterns and copy them for example clap clap stamp I can recognise a more complicated pattern such as AAB I can solve real world maths problems with numbers up to 5 such as if we have 3 people coming to dinner, how many plates will we need I can use positional language such as under, on top, behind
Shape, Space and Measur e	I can chose a puzzle piece and try to fit it in I can recognise when two shapes are the same	I can complete an inset puzzle I can select appropriate shapes for building for example know that a flat surface can be stacked I can match shapes that are identical or have a different orientation or that are the same shape but a different	I can talk about and explore 2D and 3D shapes	I can select shapes appropriately when making a picture for example a square for a window or a triangle for a roof I can identify some differences between shapes such as 'pointy corners' or curved/round edges I can name some 2D shapes



		size.		
	there are no early learning goals that directly relate to shape, space and measure objectives. However, children will have experienced rich opportunities to develop their spatial reasoning skills in shape, space and measure.			



Understanding the World				
Area	Baseline	Autumn 2	Spring 2	Summer 2
Past and Present	I can say who I am and who I live with I can talk about any pets I may have I can talk about my extended family	I can say who I am and who I live with I can talk about any pets I may have I can talk about my extended family	I am beginning to notice how things change for example when a banana turns black or flowers are growing I know that I am growing up and changing (baby pictures)	I can talk about some of my own and my family's history (grandparents, parents, etc.) <i>(for Nursery children 'History' can mean yesterday or last week)</i> I am beginning to make sense of my own life story and my family's history for example when looking at photographs of myself and my family
People, culture and Communities	I can talk about my own family I can recognise photos of my friends, family and other special people and say who they are I can pretend to drink a cup of tea or look after a dolly pretending it is a baby	I can comment on recent pictures of celebrations in my life such as 'this is me celebrating diwali'	I can remember times that are special to me and talk about them such as I got a scooter for my birthday I am interested in the lives of people familiar to me such as I might ask if my friend has a brother I am beginning to have an awareness that there are other countries in the world	I Know some of the things that make me unique for example I am the tallest in my class/I am the fastest runner I can talk about similarities and differences in relation to friends or family, in people, countries and communities I am developing a positive attitude about the differences between people for example I celebrate Eid my friend celebrates Christmas



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				I am interested in some of the people who help us for example a Doctor, Nurse, Vet, Firefighter
The Natural World	I am beginning to talk about what I see in my own environment (school and home) I can talk about what I see when I play outside such as splashing in puddles or digging in mud I can use my senses to explore for example hands in natural materials or listening on sound walks I am beginning to use small world toys and link them to what I have seen (for example toy animals/farm/zoo)	I can talk about what I see in my own environment (school and home) I can use my senses to explore for example hands in natural materials or listening and sound walks I can explore the world around me and explore how things work for example begin to understand about the seasons or how to use equipment and resources in the nursery such as a rolling pin for playdough	I can talk about my home and the places that I know like the park, the shops, the library I sometimes ask questions about things in my direct environment I understand that plants are a living thing but they are different to animals and people I can plant seeds and care for them with adult support I know that a caterpillar turns into a butterfly (life cycles) I can explore and begin to talk about the different forces I can feel such as rolling toy cars down an incline and adapting the incline to see the cars go faster	I can talk about the key features of life cycles using key vocabulary such as 'it has turned into a frog/butterfly' or tadpole, cocoon, chrysalis etc I can talk about the world around us observing animals and plants using wider vocabulary (key vocab that I have been taught) I am beginning to understand that plants need light (sunshine) and water in order to grow I am happy to use my hands to explore natural materials for example natural messy sensory play such as mud, water, sand, ice, snow I am beginning to understand the need to care for the environment for example re-cycling and for caring for living things I am beginning to be able to talk about changes such as combining ingredients



				for cooking or melting ice
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Expressive Arts & Design

Creating with Materials

- Safely use and explore a variety of materials, tools and techniques, experimenting with colour, design, texture, form and function.
- Share their creations, explaining the process they have used.
- Make use of props and materials when role playing characters in narratives and stories.

Being Imaginative and Expressive

- Invent, adapt and recount narratives and stories with peers and their teacher.
- Sing a range of well-known nursery rhymes and songs.
- Perform songs, rhymes, poems and stories with others and (when appropriate) try to move in time with music.

Area	Baseline	Autumn 2	Spring 2	Summer 2
Creating with Materials	I know the names of 1 or 2 colours I can choose a colour, sometimes using the correct name I am happy to use my hands to make handprints using paint	I know the names of some colours I can choose a colour for a purpose I can draw 'potato people' (no neck or body) I am beginning to draw other things from memory I can use an object to represent something else even though it is not similar for example; I can	I can use all kinds of cardboard boxes etc to make things I can use one handed tools with greater control I can join different materials and explore different textures for example using masking tape, glue etc I understand how to use lines to enclose a space and to represent an object I can select the correct tools for a purpose such as scissors to cut	I can explore with different colours of paint I can mix paints to see what happens I can draw a happy face and a sad face I know how to use loose parts (eg I can use buttons to represent pasta on a plate during role-play) I can draw a face/ person using an enclosed space.



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		use a brick and pretend it is a car I can explore using different materials to create a picture/model		
Being Imaginative and Expressive	I can use a rolling pin and cutters with playdough I can play with familiar resources for example kettle from the home corner I can remember and sing 1 or 2 favourite songs sometimes with incorrect words I can start and stop singing with a signal I enjoy making sounds with a variety of instruments	I can use playdough in different ways for example rolls, cuts, squashes, twists I can play with familiar resources for example kettle from the home corner I can re-enact a personal experience in a simple way such as a car or train ride pretending to steer and be the driver I can sing my favourite songs from memory I can start and stop singing with a signal I can copy simple actions and patterns	I am beginning to use language I have heard, in my role play – for example calling to my friends 'It's tidy up time' or 'It's story time' imitating a teacher I can pitch my singing at a tone to copy another person (pitch match) I can remember and sing an entire short song I can make 'small world' using blocks I can sing the melodic shape of a familiar song for example; singing the word HEL-LO high and low I can use musical instruments such as shakes to express my feelings (making loader noise to represent anger) I can remember and sing a variety of songs I can respond to what I have heard I know musical instruments make different sounds	I can pretend to be somebody else during role play for example 'the mummy' or the 'baby' I can play an imaginary game with the small world for example animals or dinosaurs I can draw a representation of a person I can create a song using a tune that I know such as singing wash, wash, wash your hands to the tune of row, row, row your boat I can remember a simple sequence of movements in response to music I can develop a simple storyline in my pretend play



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		I am beginning to understand that sound can be made from different sources (environmental, instrumental , body percussion) I can imitate another person using appropriate pitch		
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